

Fun fact: every set of six numbers is just as likely to win as any other. So the next time you want to buy a lottery ticket, pick the numbers 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6. Those numbers are just as likely to come up as a more complex set.

The Program in Action

When you run *powerballlottery.py*, the output will look like this:

Powerball Lottery, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com

Each powerball lottery ticket costs \$2. The jackpot for this game is \$1.586 billion! It doesn't matter what the jackpot is, though, because the odds are 1 in 292,201,338, so you won't win.

This simulation gives you the thrill of playing without wasting money.

Enter 5 different numbers from 1 to 69, with spaces between each number. (For example: 5 17 23 42 50 51)

> 1 2 3 4 5

Enter the powerball number from 1 to 26.

> 6

How many times do you want to play? (Max: 1000000)

> 1000000

It costs \$2000000 to play 1000000 times, but don't worry. I'm sure you'll win it all back.

Press Enter to start...

The winning numbers are: 12 29 48 11 4 and 13 You lost.

The winning numbers are: 54 39 3 42 16 and 12 You lost.

The winning numbers are: 56 4 63 23 38 and 24 You lost.

--snip--

The winning numbers are: 46 29 10 62 17 and 21 You lost.

The winning numbers are: 5 20 18 65 30 and 10 You lost.

The winning numbers are: 54 30 58 10 1 and 18 You lost.

You have wasted \$2000000

Thanks for playing!

How It Works

The output from this program looks fairly uniform because the `allWinningNums.ljust(21)` code on line 109 pads the numbers with enough spaces to take up 21 columns, no matter how many digits the winning numbers have. This makes the “You lost.” text always appear in the same place on the screen, so it remains readable even as the program quickly outputs several lines.

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1. `"""Powerball Lottery, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com`
 2. `A simulation of the lottery so you can experience the thrill of`
 3. `losing the lottery without wasting your money.`
 4. `View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects`
 5. `Tags: short, humor, simulation"""`
 - 6.